

Safety first

When it comes to working with wood and really sharp things that spin really fast, you **HAVE** to be safe. More importantly, if you try to not be stupid, you'll get along just fine. While it goes without saying that your fingers should be nowhere near the saw, what a lot of people always forget to do is wear safety goggles. Human beings are dependant more on their sight than any other sense. If a tiny speck of sawdust gets in there, not only are you going to be running around like a headless chicken, you're also running the risk of sending the drill bit into your hand, a hammer into your thumb or a saw across your finger.

It's also important to dress appropriately. There will be a lot of sharp, heavy objects everywhere and a pair of worker's boots would do wonders to keep your toes safe. An apron would also come in handy. The last thing you want to do is scratch yourself with the drill bit plugged into an electric drill.

Finally, on a more serious note, the dangers of a wood workshop are very real and keeping children out is essential. It's also equally important to invest in a solid workbench so that you won't throw your back out while sawing a particularly hard piece of wood and there will always be something to firmly clamp your piece of wood to before sawing or drilling.

While picking a workbench, it's important to remember to pick or buy one that's sturdy. A general rule of thumb to be followed while checking to see if the workbench is



The ideal workbench

sturdy enough is to see how many other legs each leg is connected to under the work surface. If each leg is connected to three other legs, you're good to go. The surface of the workbench needs to be the kind that won't warp. Personal experience says, marine/water-resistant particleboard works brilliantly, most resources say that the surface should be made of strips of wood glued and screwed together. A good workbench also has a little recess underneath to leave your tools for the time being and better ones come with drawers.